Billing and Payment Operations Guide

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Billing overview

Customer billing questions can involve consumption, billing periods, rates, fixed charges, taxes, adjustments and payment status. Representatives should use the current billing system and approved procedures when discussing account-specific information. The assistant may help explain the documented process, but account values must be confirmed in the authorized system.

Explaining a bill

Before discussing account-specific billing information, the representative should complete the approved customer verification process. The representative can then explain the billing period and the components shown on the bill using the information available in the billing system. Where the customer disputes an amount, the representative should distinguish a request for explanation from a formal billing dispute.

Billing disputes

A billing dispute should contain enough information for investigation. Relevant information can include the bill number, billing period, customer's stated reason for the dispute and any available meter or account information. The representative should create or update the appropriate case and route it for specialist review when the documented conditions require investigation beyond the service desk.

Payment status

When a customer reports that a payment has not appeared, the representative should first check the payment status available in the authorized system. A pending or failed status should be handled according to the current payment-status procedure. Representatives should not ask customers to repeat a payment without first checking the available status, and they should never request or record full payment-card credentials in the service case.

Examples of related decisions

A question about why a bill is high may require review of consumption and billing information rather than an automatic meter replacement. A question about a payment that is pending belongs to the payment-status workflow. A disputed charge that requires investigation should follow the billing-dispute process.

Demonstration document. This fictional content is intended for RAG evaluation and customer demonstration only. Replace with client-approved content before production use.

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